

Morocco's Wage Landscape: An Analysis of 1.6 Million Employees

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In 2022, the database of declared employees registered with Morocco's *Caisse Nationale de Sécurité Sociale* (CNSS) was leaked and made public. The database contains declared salaries, regional information, and economic activity sectors for approximately 1.6 million employees, offering an unusually detailed cross-section of Morocco's formal labor market.

After cleaning the data (removing entries with missing or inconsistent values), the working dataset contains **1,590,950 employees** spread across **160 cities**, **22,338 declared activity sectors**, and **40,184 companies**, representing 94.6% of the raw records. Gender was inferred from first names using a name-gender mapping dictionary, achieving a 97% match rate; 33.2% of identified employees are women.

Salary Distribution

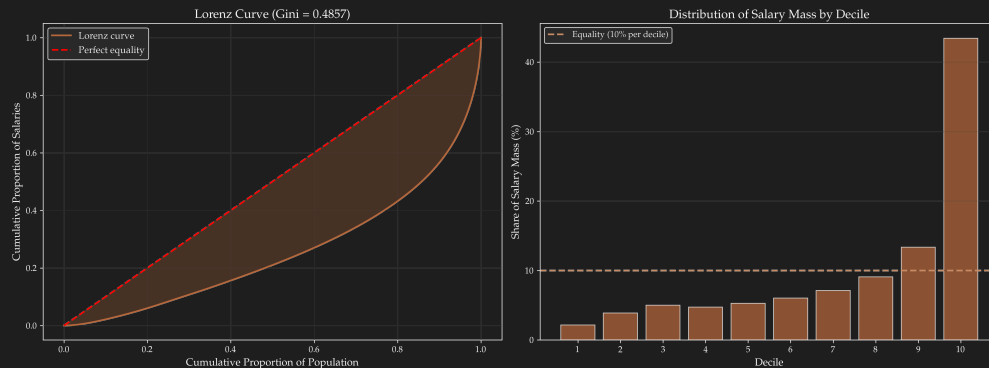
The headline figures already reveal a starkly unequal distribution:

Statistic	Value
Mean salary	6,279 DH/month
Median salary	3,538 DH/month
10th percentile	2,099 DH

Statistic	Value
25th percentile	2,970 DH
75th percentile	5,669 DH
90th percentile	11,220 DH
99th percentile	48,170 DH
Maximum	7,399,227 DH

The gap between the mean (6,279 DH) and the median (3,538 DH) is a signature of a right-skewed distribution: a relatively small number of very high earners pulls the mean well above what most workers actually take home. More than half of formal-sector employees earn under 3,538 DH per month.

The **Gini coefficient is 0.4857** — classifying Morocco’s formal-sector wage inequality as high by international standards, comparable to some of the most unequal economies in the world. The top decile captures **43.4%** of total declared wage mass; the bottom decile, just **2.2%**. The D9/D1 inter-decile ratio is **6.2x** — meaning the threshold to enter the top 10% of earners is more than six times the threshold at the bottom 10%.

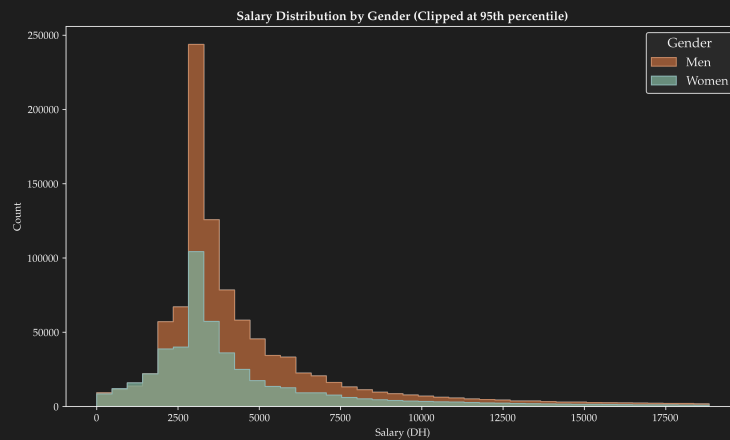


Gender Pay Gap

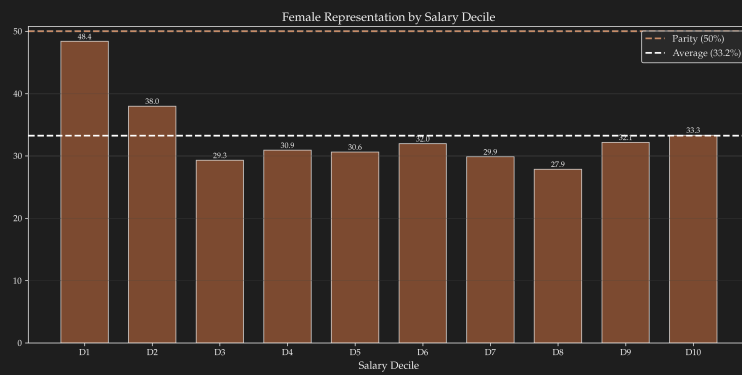
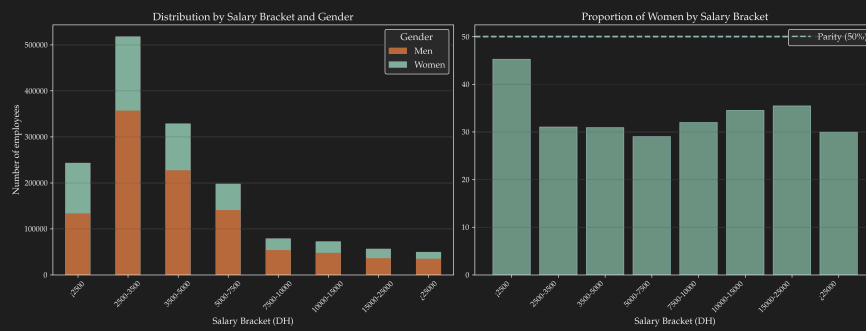
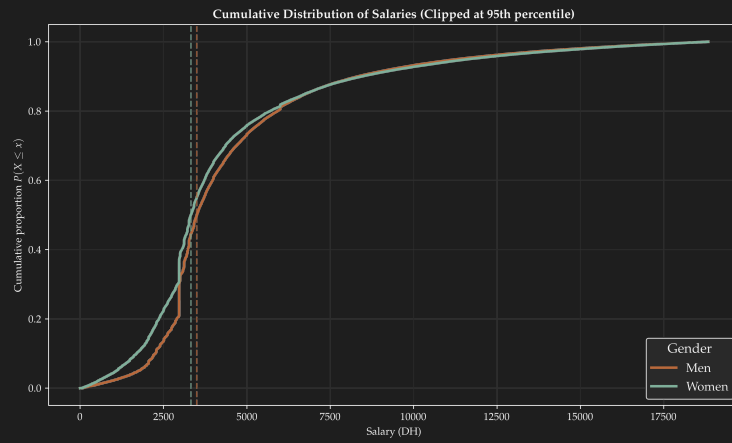
The dataset shows a persistent and statistically significant gender pay gap across all salary metrics:

	Women (515,118)	Men (1,031,308)
Mean salary	5,863 DH	6,483 DH
Median salary	3,415 DH	3,607 DH
25th percentile	2,728 DH	2,970 DH
75th percentile	5,467 DH	5,757 DH

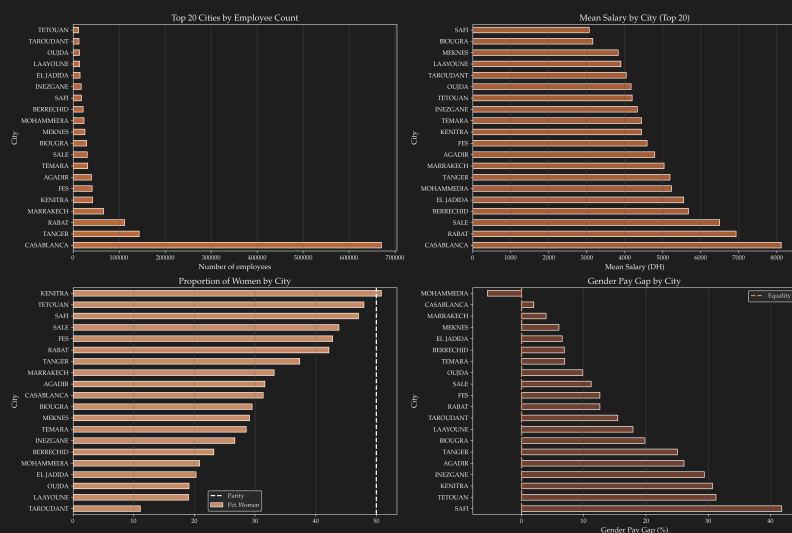
The mean-based gender pay gap stands at **9.56%** (women earn 90.4 cents for every dirham men earn), or **619 DH/month** in absolute terms — roughly 7,437 DH per year. The median-based gap is 5.32%. All three statistical tests applied (Student’s t-test, Mann-Whitney U, Kolmogorov-Smirnov) confirm the difference is highly significant ($p = 0$).



The gap is not uniform across the distribution. At a given salary level, the share of women drops as pay rises — women are overrepresented at the bottom of the distribution. In the lowest bracket (under 2,500 DH/month), women represent **45%** of workers; in brackets above 5,000 DH, they drop to around 29–35%.



Geography



Morocco's formal labor market is heavily concentrated. **Casablanca alone accounts for 43.2%** of all registered employees (670,439 workers), and the top five cities — Casablanca, Tanger, Rabat, Marrakech, and Kénitra — together represent **66.7%** of the total workforce.

Salary levels vary significantly by city, with Casablanca leading by a wide margin:

City	Mean salary (DH)	Median (DH)	% Women
Casablanca	8,115	4,131	31.4%
Rabat	6,929	3,561	42.2%
Salé	6,496	3,227	43.8%
Tanger	5,189	3,583	37.4%
Marrakech	5,034	3,624	33.2%
Agadir	4,788	3,479	31.6%
Fès	4,586	3,300	42.8%
Kénitra	4,439	3,362	50.8%
Safi	3,066	2,863	47.1%

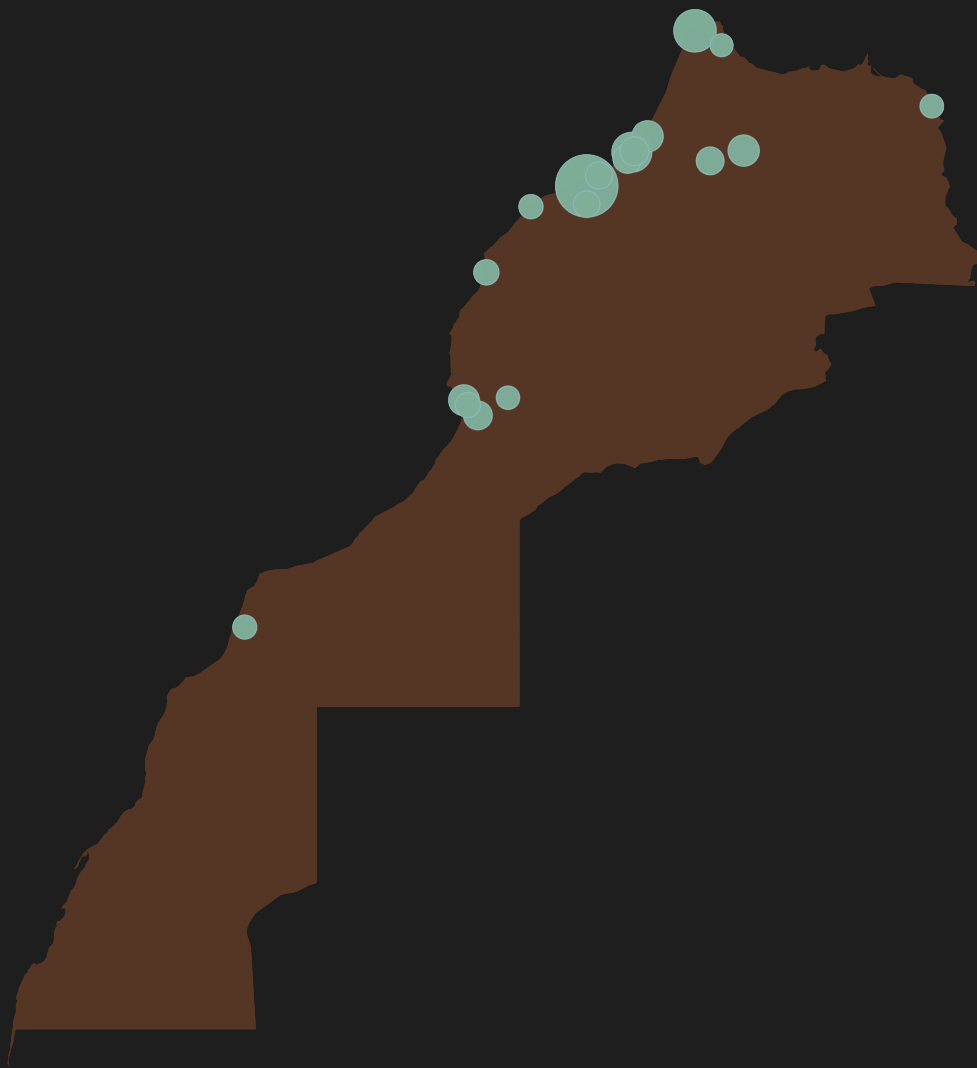
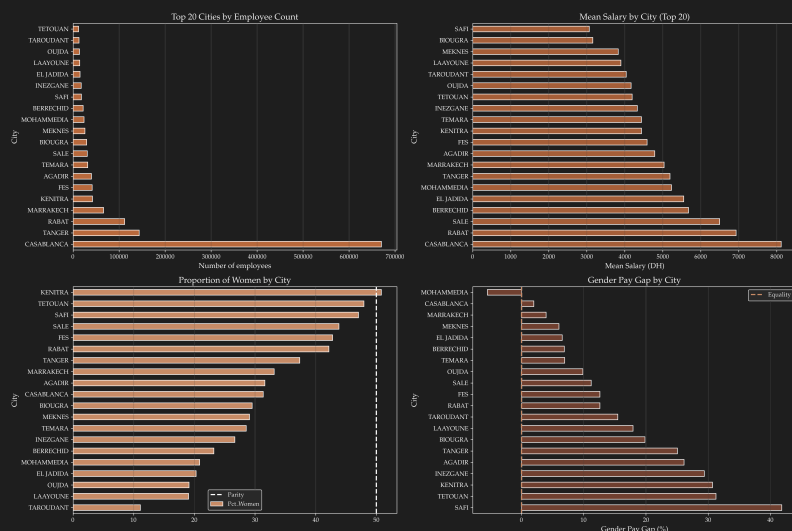


Figure 1: City employee count

The gender pay gap also varies substantially by city. The largest gaps appear in Safi (41.8%), Tétouan (31.2%), and Kénitra (30.7%). Mohammedia is the only major city where women's mean salary **exceeds** men's (by 5.5%), likely reflecting the specific industrial profile of that city.



Sector Analysis

The most common declared activity sectors are dominated by temporary labor supply, garment manufacturing, banking, agricultural work, and automotive parts manufacturing. The spread in pay across sectors is enormous:

Highest-paying sectors (mean salary):

Sector	Mean (DH)	% Women
Banking (BANQUE)	18,140	44.2%
Engineering consulting	17,448	33.1%
Banking operations support	14,712	54.9%
Automotive vehicle sales	9,395	9.5%
Multilingual telecom support	7,777	53.2%
Call centers	6,954	51.1%

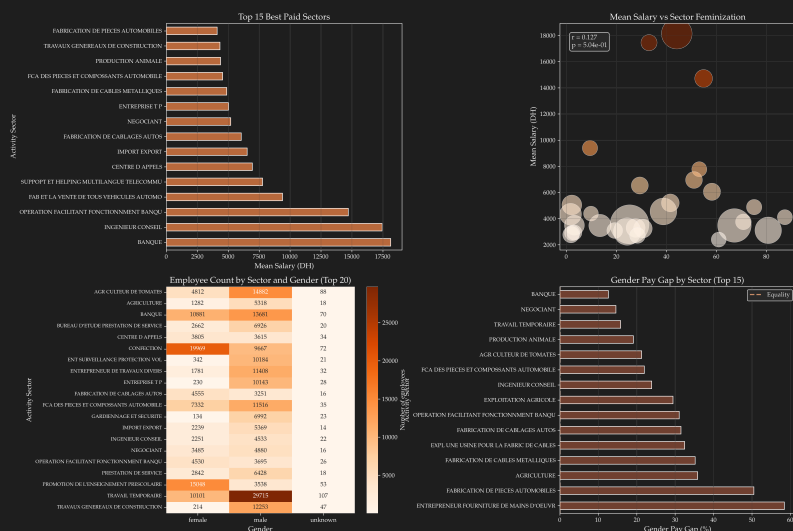
Lowest-paying sectors (mean salary):

Sector	Mean (DH)	% Women
Labor/manpower supply	2,400	60.9%
Agricultural exploitation	2,713	—
Security / guarding	2,779–2,939	~3%

Sector	Mean (DH)	% Women
Tomato farming	3,014	—
Preschool education	3,108	80.7%

The pattern is stark: the most feminized sectors are also among the lowest-paid. Sectors with more than 60% female workforce — automotive parts manufacturing (87% women), preschool education (81%), garment manufacturing (67%), cable manufacturing (75%) — cluster at the bottom of the wage distribution. Conversely, the lowest-feminization sectors (construction, security, heavy industry) tend to pay more.

The sector-level gender pay gap follows a similar pattern: the largest gaps appear precisely in the most feminized industries, where women earn 50–58% less than men on average in the same sector.



Employer Concentration

The labor market is highly fragmented. The **Herfindahl-Hirschman Index (HHI)** is 18.34, well below the threshold

that would indicate concentration. The top 20 employers together account for only **14%** of total jobs. No single employer commands more than ~2% of the workforce.

The largest employers are dominated by temporary staffing agencies (TECTRA, 32,583 employees), agricultural conglomerates (SA STE MARAISSA, 19,782), automotive manufacturers (LEAR AUTOMOTIVE MOROCCO, 18,883), and the preschool education foundation FONDA MAROC (18,639).

The highest-paying companies tell a very different story, smaller, concentrated in finance, holding groups, and multinationals:

Company	Mean salary (DH)	Employees
SIGER	362,848	6
AL MADA	328,936	62
ZALAR HOLDING	238,692	21
MICROSOFT MAROC	183,574	35
NAREVA HOLDING	108,365	67
AKWA GROUP	92,180	—
PHILIP MORRIS MAROC	90,203	—
COCA-COLA MAROC	88,837	—

The Top 1%

The top 1% of earners (15,505 individuals) sit above a threshold of **48,170 DH/month**, with a mean of **87,630 DH** and a maximum of **7,399,227 DH** — over 7.3 million dirhams per month, declared to CNSS.

The ten highest individual salaries in the database:

Name	Monthly salary (DH)	Company
OURIAGLI MOHAMMED HASSAN	7,399,227	AL MADA
TAUD AYMANE	3,611,795	NAREVA HOLDING
TAZLAOUI ABDELMJID	2,750,475	STE ONAPAR AMETYS
KESSAR NOUFISSA	2,465,852	AL MADA
ZEMZAMI AISSA	2,310,000	FIRST MATERIEL SARL
EL MAJIDI MOHAMMED MOUNIR	1,688,872	ATELIER NUMERIQUE
HARAKAT HICHAM	1,547,971	SA STE MARAISSA

Name	Monthly salary (DH)	Company
EL HABTEY RACHID	1,462,105	TOURISME ET D'ANIMATION
MAKRAM TARIQ	1,340,529	AL MADA
BAKKAL SANAA	1,284,237	AL MADA

Summary

A few structural features stand out from this dataset:

- **The median formal-sector salary in Morocco is 3,538 DH/month** — less than €320. More than half the registered workforce earns below this figure.
- **Inequality is high:** a Gini of 0.49 and a top decile capturing 43% of total wages. The formal labor market mirrors, and probably understates, the broader wealth distribution.
- **The gender pay gap is real, significant, and structural:** women are overrepresented in the lowest-paid sectors and brackets. The gap widens in the most feminized industries, not because women are in different jobs, but because the jobs that attract more women systematically pay less.
- **Geography concentrates opportunity:** Casablanca accounts for 43% of all formal employment and pays almost double the median salary of smaller cities.
- **The labor market is formally fragmented** but the top of the distribution is extremely concentrated — a handful of holding companies and multinationals account for the highest-earning individuals.